There is no doubt that security measures are necessary to ensure the proper functioning of the security services. Exposing the identity of agents or sources undermines their ability to continue collecting information and endangers their lives and the lives of others. The publication of methods and means and information about cryptology encourages adversaries to develop countermeasures and impair our abilities. Further, the inability of a government to keep its secrets leads friendly countries to lose their confidence in us and decreases their willingness to share their secrets with us.

Secrecy also plays a major role in diplomacy. Kissinger's first visit to China proved that diplomatic initiatives can open channels of communication with hostile actors only if they are kept secret. The Oslo Accords with the Palestinians were made possible only by the secrecy with which they were achieved. The lack of progress in negotiations with Syria was in large part due to President Assad's refusal to open a secret channel of dialogue. Covert talks allow representatives of both sides to say things to each other that, if spoken publicly, could cause internal rifts, coalition trouble, and so on. Confidentiality encourages negotiations that are focused on content and helps prevent stagnation resulting from the desire not to be seen as giving up, losing face, or "blinking." To paraphrase a Jewish American judge, "Secrecy eliminates the need for the dangerous cosmetics of international political theater."

A robust economy is an indicator of national security. Military and other exports are often conditional, from the buyer's perspective, on confidentiality. A violation of the confidentiality of such transactions may have a negative impact on employment. In such cases, which principle is stronger? The right of the public to know or the preservation of jobs? In the renowned ruling of *New York Times v. United States*, 403 U.S. 713 (1971), commonly known as the Pentagon Papers Case, Justice Potter Stewart, who was one of the six majority judges, wrote: "In the absence of the governmental checks and balances present in other areas of our national life, the only effective restraint upon executive policy and power in the areas of national defense and international affairs may lie in an enlightened citizenry — in an informed and critical public opinion which alone can here protect the values of democratic government. . . . Yet it is elementary that the successful conduct of international diplomacy and the maintenance of effective national defense require both confidentiality and secrecy. [2]